The Paid On Time Pack: Late-Payment Templates for Freelance Writers

Made for writers who would rather write than chase invoices.

How to use this pack

1. Check the invoice due date.
2. Pick the stage that matches how late the payment is.
3. Copy the template, fill in the [brackets], send.
4. Log the date in your tracker (Template 6).

Template 1: Friendly reminder (1 day after due)

Subject: Quick check-in on invoice [number]

Hi [Name],

I hope your week is going well. I wanted to check that invoice [number] for [amount], due [date], reached you. You can find the copy attached. Let me know if you need anything from me to process it.

Thanks,
[Your name]

Template 2: Firm reminder (7 days after due)

Subject: Invoice [number] is now [X] days overdue

Hi [Name],

Invoice [number] for [amount] was due on [date] and is still open. Could you let me know when I can expect payment, or whether there is an issue with the invoice I should fix?

Payment details are below:
[Bank or payment link]

Thanks,
[Your name]

Template 3: Final notice (14 days after due)

Subject: Final notice: invoice [number]

Hi [Name],

I have not yet received payment for invoice [number] ([amount], due [date]). Please arrange payment by [new date, about 7 days out]. If I do not hear back by then, I will need to pause work on [project] and may have to pass the account to a collections process.

Thanks for your prompt attention,
[Your name]

Template 4: Pause-work notice

Subject: Pausing new work until invoice [number] is settled

Hi [Name],

To keep our projects on schedule, I am pausing new work until invoice [number] is paid. Once payment arrives, I will pick up [next deliverable] within [timeframe].

Regards,
[Your name]

Template 5: Payment-received thank you

Subject: Payment received, thank you

Hi [Name],

Thanks for settling invoice [number]. It's much appreciated. I'm looking forward to [next project].

Best,
[Your name]

Template 6: Chase tracker (copy into a spreadsheet)

Client	Invoice #	Amount	Due date	Reminder 1	Reminder 2	Final notice	Paid on

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Checklist: before you send any invoice

- [ ] Client's legal name and billing contact confirmed
- [ ] Purchase order number included, if the client uses one
- [ ] Clear due date (for example "Net 14")
- [ ] Payment method and bank or payment link included
- [ ] Late-payment terms stated in the invoice footer
- [ ] Copy saved to your tracker

Checklist: your weekly chase routine (15 minutes)

- [ ] Open the tracker
- [ ] Mark any invoices paid this week
- [ ] Send the next template for anything overdue
- [ ] Pause new work for any client more than 14 days late

Thanks for reading. Good luck getting paid on time.